

FILM DOSSIER: DOCTOR STRANGE: THE BLACK PRIESTS

Phase 4 · Film #3 (Saga Two, Film #3 · Overall Film #32)

Status:  DOSSIER COMPLETE (awaiting showrunner lock)

1. IDENTITY

Field	Entry
Film #	Saga Two #3 (Phase 4, Film #3) · MCU #32
Phase	Phase 4, The Secret Wars Saga
Real title	<i>DOCTOR STRANGE: THE BLACK PRIESTS</i>
Decoy / codename title	<i>"NIGHT CLASS"</i>
Release date	Friday, May 6, 2022
Distributor	Walt Disney Studios Motion Pictures
Director	Scott Derrickson
Rating / runtime	PG-13 · 158 minutes
Genre + second genre	Superhero action-adventure + occult horror / moral tragedy

2. OWNERSHIP

Field	Entry
Whose film / franchise is this?	BENEDICT CUMBERBATCH (Doctor Strange, film 2 of the franchise)

Character	Actor	Age at release
Dr. Stephen Strange	Benedict Cumberbatch	45
Wong	Benedict Wong	50
The Ancient One	Tilda Swinton	61
Clea	Charlize Theron	46
THE ILLUMINATI: Tony Stark · Reed Richards · Namor · Shuri/Black Panther · Black Bolt · Hank McCoy/Beast	Marc-Anthony Bullock · Pedro Pascal · Tenoch Huerta · Letitia Wright · Anson Mount · Nicholas Hoult	40 / 47 / 41 / 28 / 49 / 32
Captain America	Tyrese Avery	40
Doctor Doom (<i>post-credit</i>)	Robert Downey Jr.	57
The Black Swan (Yabbith Hlaw)	Fresh casting	–
The Black Priests	Fresh casting	–
The Sun God (<i>the Great Society</i>)	Fresh casting	–

3. SOURCE MATERIAL (EARTH-616)

Field	Entry
Primary comic(s) adapted	Jonathan Hickman's <i>New Avengers</i> vol. 3 #1–3 (2013): the Illuminati re-form after an Incursion over Wakanda, the Black Swan , and the Illuminati mind-wipe Captain America when he refuses their terrible choice. <i>New Avengers</i> vol. 3 #7–12 (2013): " A Perfect World ," the incursion of the Great Society's Earth. <i>New Avengers</i> vol. 3 #13–? (2014): Doctor Strange turns to dark magic and the Black Priests .
Supporting comics	<i>Doctor Strange</i> (1974, Strange becomes Sorcerer Supreme when the Ancient One dies) · <i>New Avengers</i> vol. 3 #23 (2014, Strange's dark bargain) · <i>New Avengers</i> vol. 3 #33 (2015): Doom becomes Sorcerer Supreme (seeded)
Nerf check	✅ Strange's new dark power is overwhelming. He destroys a whole Earth by himself. The Great Society is as powerful as the Avengers .

3A. COMIC ACCURACY REPORT

Field	Entry
Overall accuracy score	95%. Hickman's <i>New Avengers</i> #1–12 is adapted closely, with the Ancient One's death and Strange's rise from 616.

Straight from the page:

- **An Incursion:** another universe's Earth **touches ours at one point**. Unless **one Earth is destroyed, both universes die** (NA #1).
- **The Black Swan**, a survivor from another reality, warns them (NA #1).
- **The Illuminati re-form:** Iron Man, Mr. Fantastic, **Black Panther** (Shuri), Namor, Black Bolt, Doctor Strange, and **Beast** in place of Xavier (NA #1).
- **Captain America refuses** to destroy another Earth. **The Illuminati wipe his memory of the meeting** (NA #3).
- **The Great Society**, a heroic team from the other Earth, is **about to destroy ours** (NA #7–12).
- **Strange makes a dark bargain for power** and **destroys the other Earth** (NA #13+).
- **The Black Priests** then come to collect (NA 2014).
- **The Ancient One dies**, and **Strange becomes Sorcerer Supreme** (616).

Changes and why:

| Change | Why |

|---|---|

| **Shuri** holds Wakanda's Illuminati seat | Real history, locked by the showrunner |

| **Beast** is in the Illuminati **alongside** a living Xavier | On 616 Xavier was dead. Here **Xavier refuses to join**, and **Beast goes in his place**. |

POWERS & ABILITIES

Character	616 powers & abilities	Shown in this film	Held back (why)	Match
Doctor Strange (dark power)	Sorcerer Supreme; forbidden black magic from the bargain	Destroys an entire Earth , and holds off the Great Society alone	—	✓ 100%
The Great Society	The Sun God (planet-level solar power); a Batman-type strategist; and the rest	They fight the Illuminati to a draw	—	✓ 100%
Black Bolt	His voice: a whisper can level a city; flight; energy manipulation	Speaks one word to stop the Sun God	—	✓ 100%
The Black Priests	Masters of dark magic from the dimension of the bargain	Hunt Strange	—	✓ 100%

4. STORY

Field	Entry
Logline	To save our universe, Earth's smartest heroes decide someone else's world has to die. Stephen Strange is the one who pays for it.
Theme	The price of power. Strange gives up his soul to save the world. Was it worth it?
Villain / antagonist	The Black Priests (main); the Great Society (heroes on the other side); the Illuminati's own consciences

What the movie is about

ACT ONE: EVERYTHING DIES

- **Monday, October 4, 2021**, the morning after the Namor post-credit scene. **Shuri** summons the **Illuminati** to Wakanda.
- The **Black Swan** explains: **Incursions**. If two Earths meet, both universes die, unless **one Earth is destroyed**.
- **Xavier refuses**: "*I won't be party to genocide.*" **Beast** comes in his place.
- **Captain America**, invited by Tony, **refuses**. "*We don't trade lives.*"
- **The Illuminati wipe Cap's memory of the meeting**. Strange casts the spell, and his hands are shaking.

ACT TWO: A PERFECT WORLD

- **Saturday, March 19, 2022**. A second Incursion. **Another Earth** hangs over the Pacific. Its heroes, **the Great Society**, are coming to **destroy ours**.
- **The Ancient One**, dying, makes Strange **Sorcerer Supreme**: "*Now it is on you, Stephen.*" She dies.
- The Illuminati fight the Great Society on the edge of both worlds. **They're losing**.

ACT THREE: THE BARGAIN

- Strange goes to a realm he's never been to, and **makes a deal**.
 - He **comes back changed**: his eyes are black, and his voice has too many echoes.
 - **Strange destroys the Great Society's Earth**. Billions die in an instant. Our universe is saved.
 - **The Black Priests** arrive to **collect their price**. Strange fights them off, but they'll be back.
 - In the Sanctum, **Wong** watches Strange scrub his hands over and over. **Clea**: "*Stephen. What did you give them?*" He doesn't answer.
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5. MCU TIMELINE PLACEMENT

Field	Entry
When it's set	Monday, October 4, 2021 → Monday, March 21, 2022.
Where it's set	Wakanda (the Necropolis) · the Sanctum Sanctorum · Kamar-Taj · the Pacific, between two Earths · the Black Priests' dimension
Relative to other films	It picks up directly from <i>Namor's</i> post-credit scene.

6. WORLD-BUILDING

The film's own world

- **Strange as Sorcerer Supreme**, and **Strange corrupted**.
- **The Black Priests**, whose debt is still unpaid.

World-building for the wider MCU

Seed	How it appears	Payoff
Cap's memory wipe	The Illuminati's secret	Phase 5, <i>Time Runs Out</i> : Cap remembers
The Illuminati are a secret society	They meet in the dark	The whole saga

Setting up the Big Bad (THE SECRET WARS SAGA)

Seed	How it appears	What it means
Doom wants the title	The post-credit scene	On 616, Doom becomes Sorcerer Supreme (NA #33, 2015)

7. POST-CREDIT SCENES

Field	Entry
Mid-credit scene	✓ "FORGETTING." Avengers Mansion. Cap wakes up on a couch with a headache and no idea how he got there. Tony hands him coffee without looking at him.
Post-credit scene	✓ "SUCCESSION." The Ancient One's grave in Kamar-Taj, in the snow. A figure in green and steel stands over it: Doom . DOOM: <i>"She chose the wrong student."</i> He lays a single black flower on the grave. CUT TO BLACK. "DOCTOR STRANGE WILL RETURN."
Secret shoot codenames	Mid-credit: "HANGOVER." Post-credit: "FLOWERS."

CHECKLIST

- [x] Comic(s) adapted · [x] Comic Accuracy Report + powers · [x] Real and decoy titles · [x] What it's about · [x] Villain · [x] Post-credit scenes · [x] The film's own world-building · [x] MCU world-building · [x] Big Bad setup · [x] Whose franchise · [x] When and where in the timeline